Reading Guide

S3

Yordan Markov

2024 - 2025

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Version Control

- **Version 1.0 - 29.09.2024**

First rough version, before first portfolio check.

- **Version 2.0 - 10.11.2024**

Added a retrospective after each project. Filled in around 70% of the Client project.

- **Version 3.0 - 22.12.2024**

Finalized the Client project. Filled in 40% of the Passion project.

- **Version 4.0 - 19.01.2025**

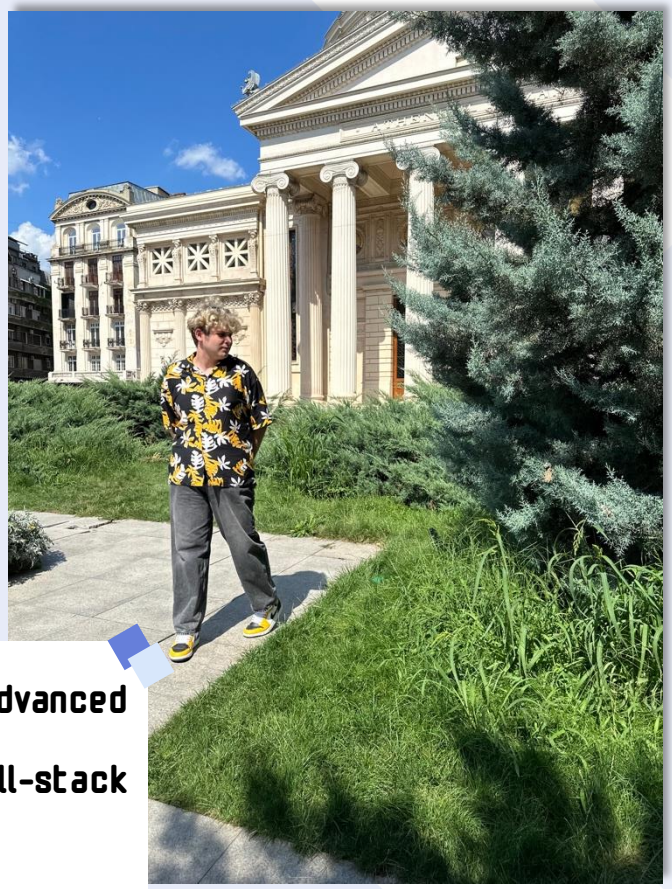
Finalized the Passion project. Added a brand-new section: Hall of Fame, representing my proudest moments during semester 3.

About me

Yordan Markov

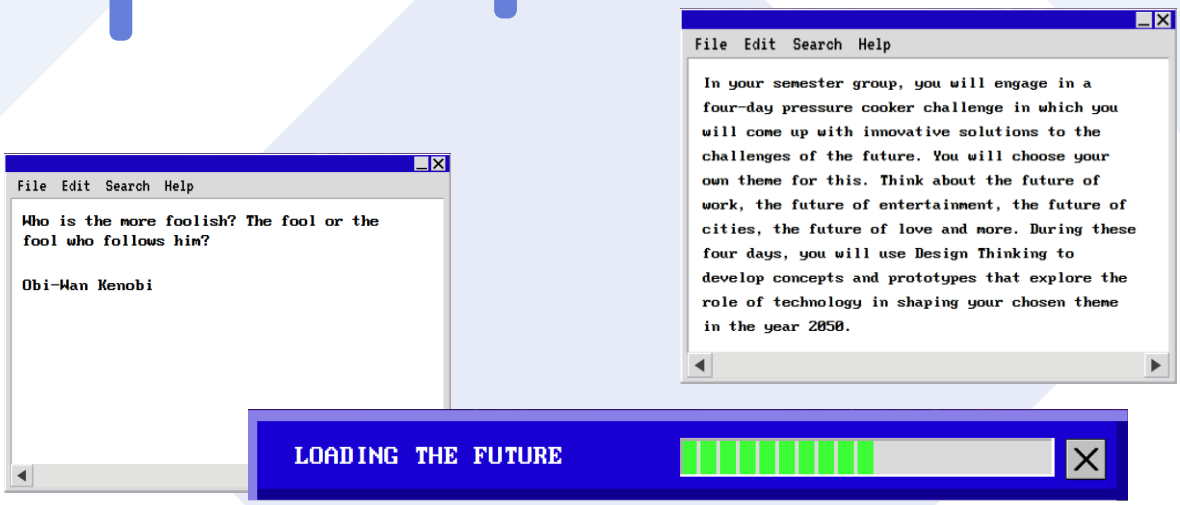
Hello, I am Yordan! I am 20 years old, and I come from Sofia, Bulgaria! My hobbies are reading, gaming and I especially love cooking delicious meals!

My talents are involved with coding. I think logically and implement project diligently. However, I cannot hide my interest in designing.



In the future I would like to be advanced in the ICT field and work as a full-stack developer.

Fast Forward



Fontys provided fun activities during the introduction week in the [Fast Forward] project. The task was to think of an idea in a specific field that would be useful in 2050. We started with the ideation, continued with the research phase and ended with the development.

Our idea was to form a bubble around a city, for instance Utrecht, and protect it from the harsh environment and other natural disasters.

I worked on:

- [Small research] for the idea and defining the current problem.
- [Sketching] the idea to form what if questions.
- Help and create figures for the [prototype] made from clay.

At the end of the week, I found myself with new friends and great teammates to work with till the end of semester 3.

Retrospective

What went well?

The team was randomly allocated, and I feel lucky with my teammates. The idea was innovative, and the team agreed almost instantly with it. The final product received nice feedback on the presenting day.

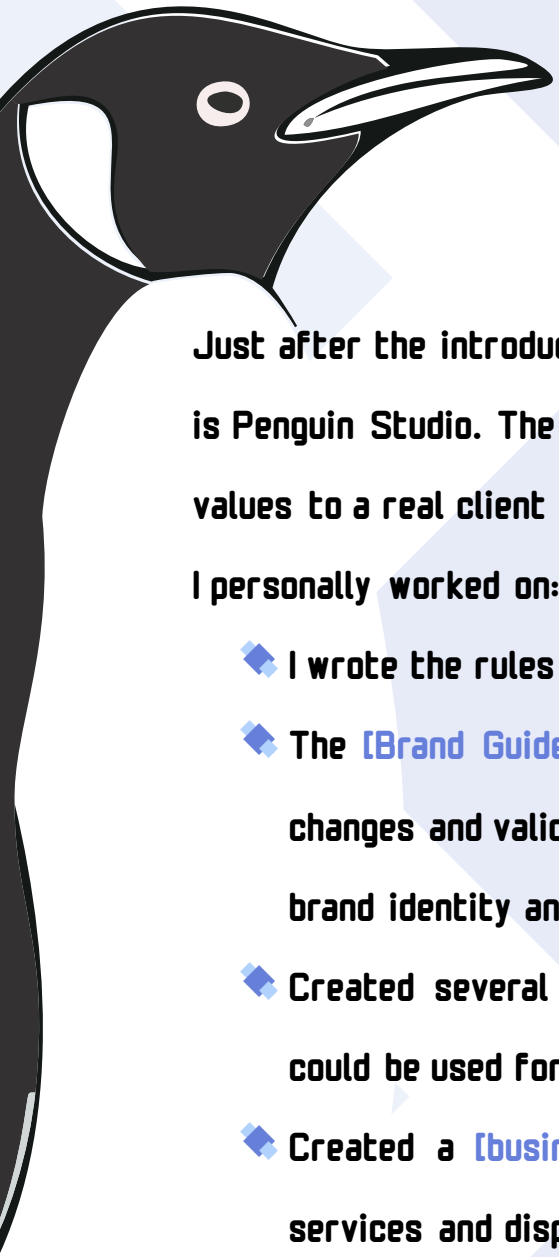
What did not go well?

Since most of the people in the team have never met each other before, the lack of communication was a real problem. The workflow was slow due to the absence of information provided by Fontys for some parts of the project.

What did I learn?

Participating in the introduction week, as known as Fast Forward, gave me crucial information about the upcoming days in this semester and I am thankful for that. I also understood better the practice of having a prototype.

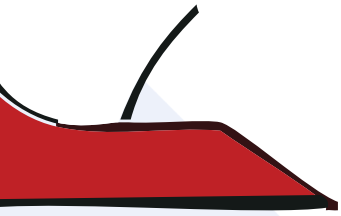
Build your own studio



Just after the introduction week the team had to build a studio. Our name is Penguin Studio. The aim of it is to represent our identity, workflow and values to a real client who we will work with on the next project.

I personally worked on:

- I wrote the rules in the [Team Charter].
- The [Brand Guide] - I got feedback for it, added the logos, applied changes and validated it. In there is an explanation about the studio's brand identity and the standard styles.
- Created several [stickers]. This way the studio name and identity could be used for fun decorations on bikes, laptops, phone cases etc.
- Created a [business card]. Having a business card validates our services and displays our contacts as a studio.
- Help with the development of the [website] for our studio. The website narrows the most crucial information down and proving to the clients that this studio is worth working with.



- Separating and giving some of the tasks in [Trello]. I kept the team working on time and introducing them to new tasks.

Retrospective

What went well?

The studio's identity is connected to everyone's interests. That is very rare to do nowadays because of the huge diversity. The style consistency between the different products is on the spot. Also, there is another thing that went well: the team delivered every product that we collectively thought of!

What did not go well?

The name was a tough process: it took a lot of our time to think about and definitely because of this the team proceeded slowly with the next steps. Without a name there is no logo, no brand identity.

What did I learn?

I improved my leadership skills with this project. I felt useful and proud when I delivered creative products, such as the [stickers] which were actually printed. I learned more about my teammates' coding style: this is something helpful for my logic and future task separation.

client project

When our studio was successfully created, it was time to start working on real problems with a client. The university provided useful contacts and all we had to do was to submit a [pitch]. I personally:

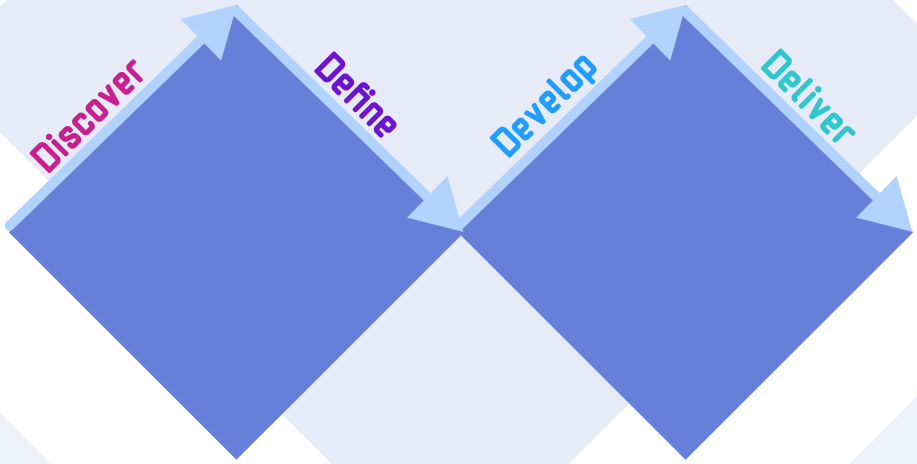
- Took part in a [video], supposed to be used as an introduction to the client.
- Created a [presentation] that combines the products the studio have so far delivered and explains a possible approach.

At the end, our semester coordinator revealed the results of the client pitches and the team got the opportunity to work with [LiveWall]. Their challenge was to think of a way to make engaging and personalized stories with AI technology for [Efteling].

To proceed with this task, I had to introduce myself to the Double Diamond method.

What is the Double Diamond method?

The [Double Diamond] is a visual representation of the design and innovation process. It is a simple way to describe the steps taken in any project: two diamonds with total of four phases: Discover, Define, Develop and Deliver.



Discover phase

This is the phase dedicated to deep research to understand the problem better.

- I assigned tasks for my teammates with [Trello] to do some research using the CMD methods.
- I did research on the topic [What is Efteling?].

- Along with a teammate, I researched the [Target audience]. With this research, I created two personas: a [mother] and a [kid].
- I initiated and took part in a brainstorming event regarding the idea the team had. Firstly, it was on a [normal board] but then it was transferred into a [Miro board].

Define phase

This is the moment when everything from the Discover phase is collected, and it is being formed into deliverables.

- I helped with ideas and feedback for the [Concept document], [Project plan] and the [MoSCoW].
- I did a [Customer Journey] map to explain the process of the target audience using the product.

Develop phase

This phase talks about itself: we develop the products explained by the previous phases.

- By following the [Brand Guide] made by my teammates, I could develop a [Poster] that informs and attracts potential users about the product we are going to deliver and a [QR Sticker] designed to provide quick access and to emphasize on the interactions.

- I created a Figma prototype on the [Characters] page to let my team members develop it.
- I have worked hard for the [code development] by focusing on the backend, consistency and combining the products the team have developed. By doing mostly the backend, I practiced for my future full-stack career.

Deliver phase

This is the finalization of the project: the product is being tested, documented etc.

- Me and my teammate Daniel conducted a [User Test] on the finished prototype.
- I created a [Documentation] for the product: explaining the process, the features and a useful appendix.

The project ended officially on 09-12-2024 with a [Final Presentation], receiving useful feedback. Hip, hip, hooray! 🎉

Retrospective

What went well?

I am very proud of how I scheduled the tasks in [Trello]. The team worked collaboratively and on time. We had a week to smooth things out and revise what we have done. The development part was the longest, yet not the hardest to manage. I am very happy with the results.

What did not go well?

Specifically on one task: improving Chat UI, I did suggest merging 4 team members to deal with it. That went bad: a lot of people could not work together on one page, and this led to repository misery. After that experience I learned my lesson and realized that it is much better to let my teammates rest rather than uniting them for a single task that can be completed even by one.

What did I learn?

I improved my leadership skills through the whole project experience. I see myself in the future being the leader of a team or a subsection. Also, for the first time in my journey at Fontys, I felt like I knew what I was doing: I practiced my previous skills, and I confirmed my knowledge.

Passion project

ЮТИЛИТИС СЪРВИСИС

The aim of the Passion project is to do something that I am passionate about and to discover which part of Media Design suits me well. Last semester for my Project X, I decided to do something for my home city Sofia in Bulgaria: [an improved prototype] of the mobility center's website for public transport schedules.

This year I took another Bulgarian initiative and a stakeholder from [Utilities Services] reached me to help him by creating a Water Calculator. Before I started working, I exchanged [a few emails] with him and began working in the well-known way: the [Double Diamond] method.

Discover phase

I assigned my tasks in [Trello] so I can check with my work constantly.

- Firstly, I researched the [current solutions] for water calculators.
- Then, I thought about the [target audience] and created [personas].

Define phase

After the brief research, I could start forming ideas.

- To make the idea clear, I wrote it down in a [concept document].
- I created a [customer journey] map to display the flow but before that I had to have a [brainstorm moment].
- Everything above helped me do a [project plan] and proceed to the next step.

Develop phase

I could now begin with the development of my product.

- Firstly, I started sketching the calculator on [Figma]: doing pages and iterations of different elements.

I had a [client meeting] on 23-12-2024 to discuss what I have done for the phases Discover, Define and my upcoming plans.

- To make the product with its own personal value, I created a [logo] for the water calculator.

- To attract new users, I also created an [engaging sticker].
- I [developed a part of the product], keeping the versions in a [Git repository].

Deliver phase

It was time to finalize what I had done for this project.

- I did a [user test] on the current prototype to gather some results and opinions from the target audience.
- I applied some of the [results after the user test] to provide a better deliverable of the prototype.
- I formed an [advisory report] to give ideas to the client about the future implementation, status and of course the strengths and weaknesses of the product.
- To conclude this phase, I wrote down all the important information as a [documentation] for the product: timeline, process and user manual.

The Passion project ended officially on 19-01-2025 but not for me. The client is interested in the actions I have taken so far and strongly desires to continue working together! 🏅

Retrospective

What went well?

My planning really went well. After scheduling the tasks and the upcoming weeks in [Trello], I could really focus on them. Also, the project was originally scheduled for 3 weeks - during the Christmas vacation I worked a lot, and I could extend it to 6 very productive weeks.

The client's communication was smooth as well: he replied quickly and gave me a large amount of feedback.

What did not go well?

I believe that the [user test] could have been better. I should have given clearer instructions and perhaps did more of the product before testing it. At least the results were helpful for the current prototype, leading to positive changes.

What did I learn?

With this project I learned more about React. My whole product is based on it and after all I understood how useful it could be. In the future I will use it again and to be honest I feel guilty for not creating my previous portfolios with it.

I also found out that I have learned a lot from Fontys: the client was really impressed with my structured work and the framework I used.

Hall of Fame

The biggest reflection

The best design

In this section, you can find out my personal proudest moments of this semester - everything collected in Hall of Fame. Reveal them by clicking on the trophies!

The best application

The most iterations

The best document

Burden of Proof

LO 1

Conceptualize, design, and develop interactive media products

Self-assessment

U O B P A

PROOF

LO 2

Transferable production

Self-assessment

U O B P A

PROOF

LO 3

Creative iterations

Self-assessment

U O B P A

PROOF

LO 4

Professional standards

Self-assessment

U O B P A

PROOF

LO 5

Personal leadership

Self-assessment

U O B P A

PROOF